

a specific database name that denotes where the table is assigned to. Unless specified, a table from a database is unable to impact the information stored in a different database. In addition to the specific database names, you also need to assign a prefix to the table. The table prefix enables web applications in database utilisation operations. Considering the main purpose of RDMS is allowing applications to retrieve and use relevant data from these databases, a table prefix helps these applications find the correct information from a large volume of data stored in the specified MySQL database. With the use of a prefix and a specific database, a MySQL table can store data simultaneously using the respective table(s).

Basic structure of a table

Each database created and managed by MySQL is built on a uniform structure. This structure contains a table, which is also built with its structured set of data elements and organisational components. The basic structure of a table consists of two components - rows and columns. Based on their structural functions, these components organise the collected data. For example, the function of a column is to specify the type of data being stored in the table while a row stores the actual data and represents its value in the table as well as the overall database. The primary advantage of the table structure is the ability to manage the tables with SQL command lines. You can modify the components of a table and clean up or reorganise by using MySQL commands. For example, if you'd like to rename a table, you can use the ALTER TABLE command.

Types of Data Supported

There are several types of data that can be stored in a MySQL database. In each database, one or more tables are used to store different types of data. The type of data stored in a table specifies the quantitative and qualitative value of the data. For example, a data type can specify if the data is numerically a decimal or an integer. You need to know the data-types before storing any information in a MySQL table/database. It helps you identify the possible value of the stored data. This value is further processed and applied for operations performed by a user through software applications.

Currently, there are over 20 different types of data supported by MySQL tables. With the advancements in data formations, you'll also be able to store information from new data-types with every passing year. As MySQL tables continue to extend their support to different formats and types of data, let's have a look at some of the most common and standard data-types supported.